

Merseyside BMX Club - Safeguarding Policy

1. Safeguarding Policy Statement

Merseyside BMX Club is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of all who participate in our activities. We believe that every rider has the right to take part in BMX in a **safe, inclusive and enjoyable environment**, free from abuse, bullying, neglect or harm.

We recognise our responsibility to act in line with **British Cycling Safeguarding Children and Young People Policy**, relevant legislation including the **Children Act 1989, The Children Act 2004, Working Together to Safeguard Children 2023** and associated statutory guidance. We also recognise that safeguarding responsibilities extend to adults at risk who participate in our activities, in line with **The Care Act, 2014**. For the purposes of this policy, a child or young person is defined as anyone under the age of 18.

2. Key Principles

- The welfare of the child is paramount
- All children have the right to protection, regardless of age, gender, disability, race, religion, sexual orientation or background
- Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility
- All concerns will be taken seriously and responded to promptly
- We will work in partnership with parents/carers, British Cycling and statutory agencies
- Children and young people should feel listened to and respected
- The club operates Codes of Conduct for coaches, volunteers, riders and parents, in line with British Cycling requirements

3. Objectives of the Policy

Merseyside BMX Club aims to:

- Provide a safe, inclusive and supportive environment for all riders
- Prevent abuse, poor practice and bullying
- Ensure concerns are reported and managed appropriately
- Appoint and support a trained **Club Welfare Officer (CWO)**
- Ensure safe recruitment, training and supervision of adults
- Review safeguarding practice regularly

This policy will be reviewed every **three years**, or sooner if legislation or British Cycling guidance changes.

4. Mandatory Safeguarding Requirements

Merseyside BMX Club will:

- Adopt and implement **British Cycling** safeguarding policies and procedures
- Appoint a named **Club Welfare Officer**
- Ensure the Club Welfare Officer holds a current **DBS check through British Cycling**
- Ensure all adults in **regulated activity (Coaching)** hold an appropriate DBS check

- Publicise **Welfare Officer** contact details to members
- Follow **British Cycling** reporting procedures
- Refer safeguarding concerns to the **British Cycling Lead Safeguarding Officer**

5. Recruitment and Training

5.1 Safer Recruitment

All roles involving responsibility for children will follow safer recruitment practices, including:

- Application and role assessment
- Self-disclosure
- References where appropriate
- DBS checks through **British Cycling**
- Clear role descriptions

Anyone subject to investigation relating to children must inform the club immediately. The matter will be referred to **British Cycling** for advice.

5.2 Training

- Safeguarding training will be provided appropriate to each role
- Safeguarding training is mandatory for anyone in regulated activity
- Training will be refreshed at least every three years

6. Complaints, Concerns and Allegations

6.1 Reporting Concerns

Any concern relating to:

- The welfare of a child
- Possible abuse or neglect
- Poor practice
- Bullying or harassment (including online)

must be reported **immediately** to the **Club Welfare Officer**.

If the concern involves the Club Welfare Officer, it must be reported directly to **British Cycling** or statutory agencies.

6.2 Responding to a Disclosure

If a child discloses abuse or raises a concern:

- Stay calm and listen carefully
- Reassure the child they have done the right thing
- Do not promise confidentiality
- Do not investigate or ask leading questions
- Record what was said as soon as possible
- Pass the information to the Welfare Officer immediately

Parents/carers will be informed unless doing so places the child at further risk.

6.3 Confidentiality and Records

- Information will only be shared on a **need-to-know basis**
- Records will be stored securely
- Information may be shared without consent where safeguarding requires it

7. Responding to Safeguarding Concerns

- All safeguarding concerns will be recorded and referred to British Cycling within **24 hours if necessary**
- If necessary for immediate safeguarding concerns, statutory services will be informed
- Temporary measures (e.g. suspension from activity) may be used as a **neutral safeguarding action**
- **British Cycling's** Case Management Group will advise on next steps
- Statutory agencies will be involved where appropriate

8. Good Practice Guidelines

8.1 Supervision

- Appropriate supervision ratios will be maintained
- Risk assessments will be completed for sessions and events
- Wherever possible, a minimum of **two adults** will be present
- Parents/carers remain responsible for children whilst they are participating in club sessions. A parent or carer must remain present at the track for the duration of the session.

8.2 Behaviour and Physical Contact

- Adults working with children are in positions of trust
- Behaviour must be professional, respectful and appropriate
- Physical contact must be necessary, proportionate and in the child's best interests
- Any physical contact should be open and observable
- Unnecessary or inappropriate contact is not permitted

8.3 Transport

- Parents/carers are responsible for transport to and from activities unless agreed in advance
- Written parental consent is required for any club-arranged transport
- Transport arrangements will be risk assessed

8.4 Social Media and Online Safety

- Online communication must be professional and appropriate
- Coaches and volunteers should not engage in private one-to-one messaging with children
- All online behaviour must reflect the club's commitment to creating a safe, inclusive and enjoyable environment for all
- Any online safeguarding concerns must be reported to the Welfare Officer

9. Anti-Bullying

Merseyside BMX Club has **zero tolerance** for bullying.

Bullying may be:

- Physical
- Verbal
- Emotional
- Discriminatory
- Online (cyberbullying)

Bullying behaviour will be addressed promptly and may result in disciplinary action in line with club and **British Cycling** procedures. Any concerns related to bullying should be reported to the **Club Welfare Officer**.

10. Children at Increased Risk

Merseyside BMX Club recognises that some children and young people may be at **increased risk of harm**, including:

- Children with **Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND)**
- Children with physical, sensory, learning or communication difficulties
- Children with diagnosed medical conditions which may impact their ability to participate fully in sessions
- Looked-after children or those with care experience
- Children from minority ethnic backgrounds
- LGBT+ children and young people
- Children who have experienced trauma or abuse
- Young athletes involved in talent or performance pathways

Children with SEND may face additional safeguarding challenges due to communication barriers, increased dependency, or difficulty recognising or reporting concerns.

The club will:

- Work closely with parents/carers and the child to understand individual needs
- Make reasonable adjustments to ensure activities are inclusive and safe
- Ensure coaches and volunteers understand additional safeguarding needs
- Put additional safeguards in place where required

11. Safeguarding Adults at Risk

Merseyside BMX Club recognises that safeguarding responsibilities may also extend to **adults at risk** who participate in our activities.

An adult at risk is a person aged 18 or over who may be unable to protect themselves from abuse, neglect or exploitation due to disability, illness, mental health needs, learning difficulties, age, or other vulnerabilities, as set out in **The Care Act 2014**.

If a coach or volunteer has a safeguarding concern about an adult rider (aged 18+), alongside reporting to British Cycling, the matter may need to be referred to the **Local Authority Adult Social Care** team.

Concerns may include:

- **Financial or material abuse** (e.g., someone exploiting an adult's money or kit).
- **Modern slavery or coercive control.**
- **Self-neglect** (e.g., an adult rider severely neglecting their own personal hygiene, health, or safety)

12. Poor Practice in Sport

Poor practice is behaviour that falls below expected standards but may not meet the threshold of abuse. This includes:

- Swearing or inappropriate language in front of children
- Favouritism or exclusion
- Inadequate supervision
- Ignoring safety guidance
- Unprofessional behaviour

Poor practice will be challenged and may be escalated if repeated or serious.

12. Useful Contacts

Merseyside BMX Club Welfare Mailbox: Email : [merseysidebmxwelfare@gmail](mailto:merseysidebmxwelfare@gmail.com)

British Cycling – Lead Safeguarding Officer

 0161 274 2000

 compliance@britishcycling.org.uk

NSPCC Helpline

 0808 800 5000

Childline (for children)

 0800 1111

Emergency Services

 999

13. Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed fully:

- Every three years (Ongoing reviews will take place annually to comply with the latest statutory guidance and best practice)
- Following any significant safeguarding incident
- When British Cycling guidance or legislation changes

Final Statement

Merseyside BMX Club is committed to creating a culture where all members feel **safe, supported and empowered**, and where safeguarding is embedded in everything we do.

Merseyside BMX Club

June 2026